María José Ñáñez-Brontë

A Life Story

This is the story of a long life, told by the people who loved her.

Zoë's “Grandmother”: Early Years in Köln & São Paulo

She was born in 1931. Her father, François, said “a child born in winter is never afraid of the cold” — and he was right. Her sister Zoë called her “la pequeña”, which she pretended to dislike.

Prices then: bread cost 5¢, a tram ticket ½ a peso, and a room was £2 a week. She wrote it all down in a notebook: naïve, façade, coöperate, Ærøskøbing, Łódź, Dvořák.

Chapter 2: The House on Calle Mayor

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What She Left Us

She left us her recipes, her stubbornness, and a garden that still comes up every spring. Thank you, abuela.